inaugurating the conference to the governor and I had the privilege of doing so for five years on the trot.

In the September 2012 conference, I was going to speak about the challenges of implementing Basel III banking regulations in India. As I got up to speak, I told the audience, with a grim face, that I had an important announcement to make before moving on to my prepared speech. I continued: 'Before coming to this event, I just signed off a paper constituting a committee to advise the Reserve Bank on payment of interest on CRR.' Some reporters present at the event texted my remarks to their anchors and editors even before I finished, and very shortly the news was on some wire agency tickers and TV scrolls. Obviously, oblivious to the stir that I had unwittingly created, I went on: 'The members of the committee will be Deputy Governor Chakrabarty and SBI Chairman Pratip Chaudhuri. They will both be locked up in a room, and will not be let out until they have reached an agreement. Also they are mandated not to reach an agreement until my tenure is over.' The audience broke into laughter. And as the reporters got the joke, they rushed to withdraw their earlier messages so as to cut losses.

Following the event, there was the usual complement of bouquets and brickbats. Some thought that I had used humour effectively to extinguish the CRR interest debate by indicating openly where I stood, while others thought that I didn't show enough discretion by joking about such a market-moving issue.

Editors' Conference

The media is a bridge between the Reserve Bank and the larger public. It disseminates our news and our messages, and critiques our policies and actions through opinion pieces and analyses. All of this enhances public understanding and gives us, within the bank, valuable feedback. This process is enhanced if the senior management of the Reserve Bank and the senior editors in the media meet occasionally to exchange views and understand each other's perspectives.